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Why a Y Combinator startup tackling AI agents for Windows gave up and pivoted



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- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

featured Amjad Masad, the founder and CEO of popular [vibe-coding startup Replit](#).

Masad, Blomfield, and YC partner David Lieb were discussing how long-term computer use of hours, rather than minutes, was still a stumbling block for agents. As the context window for reasoning grows, an agent's accuracy wavers while LLM costs increase.

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- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren't even dating apps



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Masad agreed. "The moment that technology works, those two companies are going to do really, really well," he said.

But alas, Pig's founder Erik Duntelman has already given up on the idea. In his post in May, he explained that he at first wanted to run a cloud API product (a common way of delivering AI tech). But

his customers didn't want that. So he tried selling it as a dev tool. And they didn't want that either.

"What users in the legacy app automation space actually want is to hand me money, and receive an automation," he said. Essentially, they wanted to hire a consultant to make their desired Windows robotic process automations work for them.

But Dunteman didn't want to do one-off projects.

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Probably the company furthest along on that is Microsoft. For instance, in April, [Microsoft announced](#) it added computer use tech to Copilot Studio for graphical user interfaces like Windows. That tech was released as a research preview. Plus, earlier this month, Microsoft announced [an agentic tool in Windows 11](#) that helps end users manage settings.



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Ram Iyer — 5:47 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS:

DAVID RYDER / BLOOMBERG
(PHOTOMOSH/MODIFIED) / GETTY IMAGES

Microsoft is making OpenAI's new free and open GPT model, [gpt-oss-20b](#), available to Windows 11 users via [Windows AI Foundry](#), the tech giant's platform that lets users tap AI features, APIs, and popular open source models on their computers.

The company said in a [blog post](#) that gpt-oss-20b is "tool-savvy and lightweight," adding: "Optimized for agentic tasks like code execution and tool use, it runs efficiently on a range of Windows hardware,



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Microsoft says it will bring the model to macOS soon, as well as other devices, though the company did not name any more. Microsoft is also making both gpt-oss-20b and older model gpt-oss-120b available via its hosted Azure AI Foundry platform.

The two new models are also [available on Amazon's AWS](#)

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AI dev tools for Windows get a fresh coat of paint



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AI



First impressions of Alexa+, Amazon's upgraded, AI-powered digital assistant

Sarah Perez - 14 hours ago

AI



Google takes on ChatGPT's Study Mode with new 'Guided Learning' tool in Gemini

Microsoft might not profit directly from third-party AI-powered apps on Windows. Still, by providing resources to make it easier to build AI software on the tech giant's flagship operating system, Microsoft aims to foster a flourishing ecosystem at the expense of rivals. Hence, Windows AI Foundry.

Aisha Malik · 15 hours ago

According to a press release shared with TechCrunch, Windows AI Foundry can automatically detect a Windows machine's



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